

Diacurimap 10 & 25 mg film-coated tablets

Empagliflozin

Read all of this leaflet carefully before you start taking this medicine:

- Keep this leaflet. You may need to read it again.
- If you have any further questions, ask your doctor or pharmacist.
- This medicine has been prescribed for you only. Do not pass it on to others. It may harm them, even if their symptoms are the same as yours.
- If any of the side effects gets serious, or if you notice any side effects not listed in this leaflet, please tell your doctor or pharmacist.

IN THIS LEAFLET:

- 1- What Diacurimap is and what it is used for.
- 2- Before you Take Diacurimap.
- 3- How to take Diacurimap.
- 4- Possible side effects.
- 5- How to store Diacurimap.
- 6- Further information.

1- What Diacurimap is and what it is used for:

Diacurimap contains the active substance empagliflozin.
Diacurimap is a member of a group of medicines called sodium glucose co-transporter-2 (SGLT2) inhibitors.

What Diacurimap is used for?

- Diacurimap is used to treat type 2 diabetes in adult patients (aged 18 years and older) that cannot be controlled by diet and exercise alone.
- Diacurimap can be used without other medicines in patients who cannot take metformin (another diabetes medicine).
- Diacurimap can also be used with other medicines for the treatment of diabetes. These may be medicines taken by mouth or given by injection such as insulin.
- It is important that you continue with your diet and exercise plan as told by your doctor, pharmacist or nurse.

How Diacurimap works?

Diacurimap works by blocking the SGLT2 protein in your kidneys. This causes blood sugar (glucose) to be removed in your urine. Thereby Diacurimap lowers the amount of sugar in your blood. This medicine can also help prevent heart disease.

What is type 2 diabetes?

Type 2 diabetes is a disease that comes from both your genes and your lifestyle. If you have type 2 diabetes, your pancreas does not make enough insulin to control the level of glucose in your blood, and your body is unable to use its own insulin effectively. This results in high levels of glucose in your blood which can lead to medical problems like heart disease, kidney disease, blindness, and poor circulation in your limbs.

2- Before you take Diacurimap:

a. Do not take Diacurimap: If you are allergic to empagliflozin or any of the other ingredients of this medicine (listed in section 6).

b. Take Special Care With Diacurimap:

- Talk to your doctor, pharmacist or nurse before taking this medicine, and during treatment:
- If you have "type 1 diabetes". This type usually starts when you are young and your body does not produce any insulin.
- If you experience rapid weight loss, feeling sick or being sick, stomach pain, excessive thirst, fast and deep breathing, confusion, unusual sleepiness or tiredness, a sweet smell to your breath, a sweet or metallic taste in your mouth, or a different odour to your urine or sweat, contact a doctor or the nearest hospital straight away. These symptoms could be a sign of "diabetic ketoacidosis" – a rare, but serious, sometimes life-threatening problem you can get with diabetes because of increased levels of "ketone bodies" in your urine or blood, seen in tests. The risk of developing diabetic ketoacidosis may be increased with prolonged fasting, excessive alcohol consumption, dehydration, sudden reductions in insulin dose, or a higher need of insulin due to major surgery or serious illness.
- If you have serious kidney or liver problems, your doctor may ask you to take a different medicine.
- Might be at risk of dehydration, for example:
 - If you are being sick, have diarrhoea or fever, or if you are not able to eat or drink.
 - If you are taking medicines that increase urine production [diuretics] or lower blood pressure.
 - If you are over 75 years old.

Possible signs are listed in section 4 under 'dehydration'. Your doctor may ask you to stop taking Diacurimap until you recover to prevent loss of too much body fluid. Ask about ways to prevent dehydration.

- If you are 85 years old or older as you should not start taking Diacurimap.
- If you have a serious infection of the kidney or the urinary tract with fever. Your doctor

may ask you to stop taking Diacurimap until you have recovered.

- Talk to your doctor immediately if you develop a combination of symptoms of pain, tenderness, redness, or swelling of the genitals or the area between the genitals and the anus with fever or feeling generally unwell. These symptoms could be a sign of a rare but serious or even life-threatening infection, called necrotising fasciitis of the perineum or Fournier's gangrene which destroys the tissue under the skin. Fournier's gangrene has to be treated immediately.

Foot care: Like for all diabetic patients it is important to check your feet regularly and adhere to any other advice regarding foot care given by your health care professional.

Urine glucose: Because of how this medicine works, your urine will test positive for sugar while you are taking this medicine.

Children and adolescents: Diacurimap is not recommended for children and adolescents under 18 years, because it has not been studied in these patients.

c. Taking other medicines, herbal or dietary supplements:

- Please tell your doctor or pharmacist if you are taking or have recently taken any other medicines, including medicines obtained without prescription.
- It is important to tell your doctor:
- If you are taking medicines that increase urine production (diuretics). Your doctor may ask you to stop taking Diacurimap. Possible signs of losing too much fluid from your body are listed in section 4.
- If you are taking other medicines that lower the amount of sugar in your blood such as insulin or a "sulphonylurea" medicine. Your doctor may want to lower the dose of these other medicines, to prevent your blood sugar levels from getting too low (hypoglycaemia).

d. Pregnancy and Breast-feeding:

- Pregnancy Category C.
- Empagliflozin has been shown maternal toxicity, malformations of limb bones increased in fetuses in rats when given in doses 154 times the 25 mg maximum clinical dose.
- Empagliflozin has been shown maternal toxicity in rabbits when given in doses 139 times the 25 mg maximum clinical dose.
- There are no adequate and well-controlled studies in pregnant women. Empagliflozin should be used during pregnancy only if the potential benefit justifies the potential risk to the fetus.
- If you are pregnant or breast-feeding, think you may be pregnant or are planning to have a baby, ask your doctor or pharmacist for advice before taking this medicine. Do not use Diacurimap if you are pregnant. It is unknown if Diacurimap is harmful to the unborn child. Do not use Diacurimap if you are breast-feeding. It is not known if Diacurimap passes into human breast milk.
- Ask your doctor or pharmacist for advice before taking any medicine.

e. Driving and Using Machines:

- Diacurimap has minor influence on the ability to drive and use machines.
- Taking this medicine in combination with medicines called sulphonylureas or with insulin can cause blood sugar levels to drop too low (hypoglycaemia), which may cause symptoms such as shaking, sweating and change in vision, and may affect your ability to drive and use machines.
- Do not drive or use any tools or machines, if you feel dizzy while taking Diacurimap.

f. Important information about some of the ingredients of Diacurimap:

- Diacurimap contains lactose (milk sugar). If you have been told by your doctor that you have an intolerance to some sugars, contact your doctor before taking this medicine.
- This medicine contains less than 1 mmol sodium (23 mg) per tablet that is to say essentially "sodium free".

3- How To Take Diacurimap:

- Always take Diacurimap exactly as your doctor or health care provider has told you. You should check with your doctor or pharmacist if you are not sure.

How much to take:

- The starting dose of Diacurimap is one 10 mg tablet once a day. Your doctor will decide whether to increase your dose to 25 mg once a day.
- Your doctor may limit your dose to 10 mg once a day if you have a kidney problem.
- Your doctor will prescribe the strength that is right for you. Do not change your dose unless your doctor has told you to.

Taking this medicine:

- Swallow the tablet whole with water.
- You can take the tablet with or without food.
- You can take the tablet at any time of the day. However, try to take it at the same time each day.
- This will help you to remember to take it.
- Your doctor may prescribe Diacurimap together with another diabetes medicine. Remember to take all medicines as directed by your doctor to achieve the best results for your health.
- Appropriate diet and exercise help your body use its blood sugar better. It is important to stay on the diet and exercise program recommended by your doctor while taking Diacurimap.

a. If you take more Diacurimap than you should: If you take more Diacurimap than you

should, talk to a doctor immediately or go to a hospital immediately. Take the medicine pack with you.

- b. If you forget to take Diacurimap: What to do if you forget to take a tablet depends on how long it is until your next dose.
- If it is 12 hours or more until your next dose, take Diacurimap as soon as you remember.
- Then take your next dose at the usual time.
- If it is less than 12 hours until your next dose, skip the missed dose. Then take your next dose at the usual time.
- Do not take a double dose of Diacurimap to make up for a forgotten dose.

c. If you stop taking Diacurimap: Do not stop taking Diacurimap without first consulting your doctor. Your blood sugar levels may increase when you stop taking Diacurimap.

- If you have any further questions on the use of this product, ask your doctor or pharmacist.

4- Possible Side Effects:

- Like all medicines, Diacurimap can cause side effects, although not everybody gets them.
- **Contact a doctor or the nearest hospital straight away if you have any of the following side effects:**
- **Severe allergic reaction, seen with unknown frequency (frequency cannot be estimated from the available data):**
- Possible signs of severe allergic reaction may include:
- Swelling of the face, lips, mouth, tongue, or throat that may lead to difficulty breathing or swallowing.

- Diabetic ketoacidosis, seen rarely (may affect up to 1 in 1,000 people):

- These are the signs of diabetic ketoacidosis (see also section 2, 'Before You Take Diacurimap'):

- Increased levels of "ketone bodies" in your urine or blood.
- Rapid weight loss.
- Feeling sick or being sick.
- Stomach pain.
- Excessive thirst.
- Fast and deep breathing.
- Confusion.
- Unusual sleepiness or tiredness.
- A sweet smell to your breath, a sweet or metallic taste in your mouth or a different odour to your urine or sweat.

This may occur regardless of blood glucose level. Your doctor may decide to temporarily or permanently stop your treatment with Diacurimap.

- Contact your doctor as soon as possible if you notice the following side effects:

Low blood sugar (hypoglycaemia), seen very commonly (may affect more than 1 in 10 people):

- If you take Diacurimap with another medicine that can cause low blood sugar, such as a sulphonylurea or insulin, your risk of getting low blood sugar is higher. The signs of low blood sugar may include:
- Shaking, sweating, feeling very anxious or confused, fast heart beat.
- Excessive hunger, headache.
- Your doctor will tell you how to treat low blood sugar levels and what to do if you get any of the signs above. If you have symptoms of low blood sugar, eat glucose tablets, a high sugar snack or drink fruit juice. Measure your blood sugar if possible and rest.

- Urinary tract infection, seen commonly (may affect up to 1 in 10 people):

- The signs of urinary tract infection are:
- Burning sensation when passing urine.
- Urine that appears cloudy.
- Pain in the pelvis, or mid-back pain (when kidneys are infected).

- An urge to pass urine or more frequent urination may be due to the way Diacurimap works, but they can also be signs of urinary tract infection. If you note an increase in such symptoms, you should also contact your doctor.

- Dehydration, seen uncommonly (may affect up to 1 in 100 people):

- The signs of dehydration are not specific, but may include:
- Unusual thirst.
- Lightheadedness or dizziness upon standing.
- Fainting or loss of consciousness.

- Other side effects while taking Diacurimap:

- Common:
- Genital yeast infection (thrush).
- Passing more urine than usual or needing to pass urine more often.
- Itching.
- Rash or red skin, this may be itchy and include raised bumps, oozing fluid or blisters.
- Thirst.
- Blood tests may show an increase in blood fat (cholesterol) levels in your blood.

- Uncommon:
- Hives.
- Straining or pain when emptying the bladder.
- Blood tests may show a decrease in kidney function (creatinine or urea).
- Blood tests may show increases in the amount of red blood cells in your blood (haematocrit).
- Not known:
- Necrotising fasciitis of the perineum or Fournier's gangrene, a serious soft tissue infection of the genitals or the area between the genitals and the anus.
- If any of the side effects gets serious, or if you notice any side effects not listed in this leaflet, please tell your doctor or pharmacist.

5. How To Store Diacurimap:

- Keep out of the reach and sight of children.
- Do not store above 30° C. Store in the original carton.
- Do not use Diacurimap after the expiry date which is stated on the carton after EXP. The expiry date refers to the last day of that month.
- This medicine does not require any special storage conditions.
- Medicines should not be disposed of via wastewater or household waste. Ask your pharmacist how to dispose of medicines you no longer use. These measures will help protect the environment.

6- FURTHER INFORMATION:

a. What Diacurimap contains:

- The active substance is empagliflozin.
- Each tablet contains 10 mg or 25 mg empagliflozin.
- The other ingredients are:
- Core Tablet: Microcrystalline cellulose, lactose monohydrate, croscarmellose sodium, hydroxypropyl Cellulose, colloidal silicon dioxide, magnesium Stearate.
- Film Coating: Hydroxypropyl methylcellulose, polyethylene glycol 6000, talc purified, titanium dioxide, yellow iron oxide.

b. What Diacurimap looks like and contents of the pack:

- Diacurimap 10 mg: Faint yellow to yellow round, biconvex film coated tablet engraved with M from one side and A from the other side.
- Diacurimap 25 mg: Faint yellow to Yellow round, biconvex film coated tablet engraved with M from one side and A from the other side.
- Diacurimap is available in a carton box containing 3 blisters (Opaque white Alu/PVDC) each of 10 tablets and insert leaflet.

c. Marketing Authorisation Holder and Manufacturer:

Apex Pharma - Jeddah – Rabegh – King Abdullah Economic City, Zip code: 21955, P. O. Box: 42 - Tel: 0125542201 - E-mail :pv@apexpharmasa.com.

- For any information about this medicinal product, please contact the local representative of the Marketing Authorisation Holder: Apex Pharma, Jeddah – Rabegh – King Abdullah Economic City, Zip code: 21955- P. O. Box: 42 - Tel: 0125542201 - E-mail :pv@apexpharmasa.com.

d. This leaflet was last approved in {MM/YYYY}; version number { }

e. To report any side effect(s):

Saudi Arabia:

The National Pharmacovigilance and Drug Safety Centre (NPC):

- Fax: +966-11-205-7662
- Call NPC at +966-11-2038222, Exts: 2317-2356-2353-2354-2334-2340.
- Toll free phone: 8002490000
- E-mail: npc.drug@sfd.a
- Website: www.sfd.a/npc

Other GCC States:

- Please contact the relevant competent authority.

f. This Is A Medicament:

- A medicament is a product which affects your health. And its consumption contrary to instructions is dangerous for you.
- Strictly follow the doctor's prescription, the method of use and the instructions of the pharmacist who sold the medicine.
- The doctor and the pharmacist are the experts in medicines, their benefits and risks.
- Do not by yourself interrupt the period or treatment prescribed for you.
- Do not repeat the same prescription without consulting your doctor.
- Keep all medicaments out of reach of children.

Council of Arab Health Ministers
Union of Arab Pharmacists

g. This patient information leaflet is approved by the Saudi Food and Drug Authority.